

A FRAMEWORK IN CHAPTERS

Chapter Eighteen

Territorialism

*The native above the migrant ·
territorial origin as political category*

Territorialism is the system that ranks the native of a territory above the migrant, enforces territorial identity as political category, and extracts resources and political power from the non-native. This chapter runs it through the five domains — from the indigene certificate to the derivation fund to the slow death of the non-indigene who cannot access the state's services.

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CHAPTER 18 OF AN ONGOING FRAMEWORK

Territorialism

Territorialism is the seventeenth Fundamental Matrix. It is the system that ranks the native of a territory above the migrant, enforces territorial identity as political category, and extracts resources and political power from the non-native. The framework's outline names it alongside Ethnic Majoritarianism (Chapter 17) as the two matrices that combine to form the Nationalism intersection.

Territorialism overlaps with Ethnic Majoritarianism (Chapter 17) at the indigene/settler distinction. But the two matrices are not the same. Ethnic Majoritarianism ranks by ethnic group. Territorialism ranks by territorial origin. A Yoruba person who has lived in Kano for three generations is an ethnic Yoruba (Ethnic Majoritarianism) but a territorial non-indigene of Kano (Territorialism). A Hausa person who has lived in Lagos for three generations is an ethnic Hausa but a territorial non-indigene of Lagos. The framework separates them so that the territorial logic specifically can be studied and dismantled.

A note on method. The Interpersonal, Disciplinary, and Structural sections take the naive approach — each triad described as if happening for the first time, with no networks, residues, or Canon referenced. The Hegemonic Domain section is where Canon and Practice finally enter the picture.

READING NOTE

Same convention as Chapters 1 through 17. Every paragraph is written to be tweetable. Where you see literal blanks (____), the framework is asking you to write yourself into it. This chapter's blanks may be uncomfortable: every Nigerian who has been asked for their 'state of origin,' who has paid the non-indigene fee, or who has been told 'you are a guest here' has been inside this matrix.

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SECTION 1

1. Definition: What Territorialism Extracts, Enforces, and Removes

Territorialism is the system that ranks the native of a territory above the migrant. The theoretical foundations draw on Benedict Anderson's *Imagined Communities* (1983), which showed how territorial communities, like nations, are constructed through shared administrative categories rather than discovered as pre-existing facts. Ernest Gellner's *Nations and Nationalism* (1983) showed how the modern state creates territorial identity through standardized education and administrative boundaries.

Mahmood Mamdani's *Define and Rule* (2012) showed how the colonial state created the Native Authority system, which tied each subject to a territorial ethnic group. The colonial subject was administered through their Native Authority, which was tied to their territorial origin. The post-colonial state retained this system as the 'indigene/settler' distinction, transforming the colonial administrative category into a post-colonial political category.

For the Nigerian context, Human Rights Watch's *They Do Not Own This Place* (2006) documented the systematic discrimination against non-indigenes in education, employment, and political participation. Rotimi Suberu's work on federalism showed how the territorial structure both manages and reproduces the indigene/settler tension. Abdul Raufu Mustapha's work on ethnic and territorial politics documented the specific Nigerian configurations, particularly in the Middle Belt where the indigene/settler distinction has produced decades of violence.

Nigeria's territorial landscape is complex. The country is divided into 36 states and the Federal Capital Territory. Each state has 'indigenes' (people whose ethnic group is native to the state) and 'non-indigenes' (people who have migrated to the state, regardless of how long they have lived there). The non-indigene pays higher university fees, cannot hold certain political offices, and may be denied employment in the state civil service. The indigene/settler distinction is codified in the indigene certificate system, which is the bureaucratic instrument of Territorialism.

1.1 What Territorialism Extracts

Territorialism extracts five things. First, **the migrant's political rights**: the non-indigene cannot contest certain elections, cannot be appointed to certain positions, and cannot participate fully in the political life of the state where they live and pay taxes. Second, **the migrant's equal access to services**: the non-indigene pays higher university fees, may be denied state scholarships, and may be denied state employment.

Third, **the migrant's territorial claim**: the non-indigene who has lived in a state for three generations is still a 'settler' with no territorial claim, while the indigene who has never lived in the state has a claim by birth. Fourth, **the migrant's sense of belonging**: the non-indigene is told, directly or

indirectly, that they are a guest, that they do not belong, that they should ‘go back’ to their state of origin.

Fifth, **the territory’s resources for the native’s exclusive benefit**: the derivation principle (Section 162(2) of the 1999 Constitution) directs 13% of oil revenue to oil-producing states, but the non-indigene community in the oil-producing state receives nothing, because the derivation is for the ‘indigenes’ of the state, not for all residents. The host community agreement between corporations and indigenous communities similarly excludes non-indigene residents from benefits.

1.2 What Territorialism Enforces

Territorialism enforces four standards. First, **territorial origin as political category**: the assumption that every Nigerian has a territorial origin that determines their political access, their resource allocation, and their social standing. The ‘indigene certificate’ is the bureaucratic instrument of this categorisation.

Second, the **native’s right to rule the territory**: the assumption that the indigene has the right to the governorship, the local government chairmanship, and the traditional ruler stool. The non-indigene who contests these positions is treated as an intruder. Third, the **migrant’s duty to accept guest status**: the assumption that the non-indigene must accept their guest status, must not demand equal rights, and must be grateful for what they receive.

Fourth, the **indigene certificate as gatekeeping**: the assumption that the certificate is the necessary and sufficient proof of belonging, and that without it the person is a settler regardless of their residence, their contribution, or their investment in the territory.

1.3 What Options Territorialism Removes

Concretely, Territorialism removes the option of equal citizenship regardless of territorial origin. The Nigerian who lives in a state that is not their ‘state of origin’ is a non-indigene who pays higher fees, cannot hold certain offices, and may be denied employment. The Constitution guarantees freedom of movement and residence, but the indigene/settler system makes the exercise of that freedom costly.

It removes the option of settling without political cost. The Nigerian who moves to a new state for work, for education, or for marriage discovers that their residence does not confer belonging. It removes the option of political participation in one’s state of residence. The non-indigene who has lived in a state for decades cannot contest the governorship, cannot be appointed to certain positions, and cannot fully participate in the political life of the state where they live and pay taxes.

It removes the option of equal access to public services. The non-indigene student pays higher fees. The non-indigene worker cannot access state employment. The non-indigene family may be denied state healthcare. It removes the option of belonging to more than one territory. The Nigerian who was born in one state, raised in another, and works in a third must choose one ‘state of origin’ and accept the consequences. Each removal is enforced by the Constitution, by the state, and by the triads below.

SECTION 2 · NAIVE APPROACH

2. The Interpersonal Domain

The Interpersonal Domain contains four enforcement triads and four extraction triads. Each is described here as if happening for the first time — no networks, no residues, no Canon.

3.1 Enforcement Triad: Territorial Origin as Political Category Standard

The enforcer is the person or institution that demands the subject be classified by territorial origin. The government form that requires ‘state of origin.’ The university that requires the indigene certificate. The employer who asks ‘are you an indigene of this state?’ The political party that requires the candidate to be an indigene. The enforcement is performed by the form, by the certificate requirement, by the question, or by the party rule.

The subject conforms by classifying themselves. The conforming act is the classification itself — the subject fills in the form, obtains the certificate, answers the question, accepts the party rule. The subject who refuses classification is treated as suspicious or evasive.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The Nigerian who is classified by territorial origin loses the option to be non-territorial, which is to say, loses the option to a national identity that is not mediated by territorial origin. The Nigerian who is required to produce the indigene certificate loses the option to belonging by residence, which is to say, loses the option to a territorial claim based on investment and contribution.

The witness is the person who watches the classification and says nothing, or who themselves classify by territorial origin. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the institution that benefits from the classification — the university that uses the classification to manage admissions — without personally commanding the classification.

3.2 Enforcement Triad: Native Right to Rule Territory Standard

The enforcer is the person or institution that demands the native’s right to rule the territory. The state constitution that requires the governor to be an indigene. The local government that requires the chairman to be an indigene. The traditional council that requires the chief to be from the ruling family. The community that tells the non-indigene ‘you cannot contest here.’ The enforcement is performed by the constitutional requirement, by the local government rule, by the traditional council rule, or by the community exclusion.

The subject conforms by accepting the native’s right to rule. The conforming act is the acceptance itself — the non-indigene does not contest, does not challenge, does not demand equal political rights. The non-indigene who challenges is treated as an intruder.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The non-indigene who cannot contest the governorship loses the option to full political participation, which is to say, loses the option to self-governance in the territory where they live and pay taxes. The non-indigene who cannot be appointed to certain positions loses the option to professional advancement. The non-indigene who is told ‘you cannot contest here’ loses the option to political voice.

The witness is the person who watches the native-right-to-rule enforcement and says nothing, or who themselves benefit from indigene status. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the indigene who benefits from the exclusion of non-indigenes without personally commanding the exclusion.

3.3 Enforcement Triad: Migrant Duty to Accept Guest Status Standard

The enforcer is the person or institution that demands the migrant accept their guest status. The community elder who tells the non-indigene ‘you are a guest here.’ The neighbour who says ‘go back to your state.’ The employer who says ‘indigenes first.’ The landlord who says ‘no non-indigenes.’ The enforcement is performed by the social positioning, by the expulsion threat, by the employment preference, or by the housing discrimination.

The subject conforms by accepting the guest status. The conforming act is the acceptance itself — the non-indigene does not demand equal rights, does not challenge the preference, does not contest the discrimination. The non-indigene who demands equal rights is treated as ungrateful.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The non-indigene who accepts guest status loses the option to equal citizenship, which is to say, loses the option to a life that is not mediated by territorial origin. The non-indigene who is told ‘go back’ loses the option to security. The non-indigene who is denied housing loses the option to shelter.

The witness is the person who watches the guest-status enforcement and says nothing, or who themselves treat non-indigenes as guests. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the indigene who benefits from the migrant’s subordination without personally commanding it.

3.4 Enforcement Triad: Indigene Certificate as Gatekeeping Standard

The enforcer is the institution that requires the indigene certificate as a condition of access. The university that requires the certificate for admission. The state government that requires the certificate for employment. The political party that requires the certificate for nomination. The scholarship board that requires the certificate for the award. The enforcement is performed by the requirement, by the refusal, by the denial, or by the exclusion.

The subject conforms by obtaining the certificate or by accepting the exclusion. The conforming act is the certificate itself — the indigene produces the paper; the non-indigene cannot. The certificate is the gate, and the gatekeeper is the local government that issues it.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The non-indigene who cannot obtain the certificate loses the option to university admission at the indigene rate, which is to say, loses the option to equal

education. The non-indigene who cannot obtain the certificate loses the option to state employment. The non-indigene who cannot obtain the certificate loses the option to political nomination. The loss compounds across the life.

The witness is the person who watches the gatekeeping and says nothing, or who themselves require the certificate. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the institution that benefits from the certificate system — the university that uses the certificate to manage admissions — without personally commanding the gatekeeping.

3.5 Extraction Triad: Migrant Political Rights

The extractor is the state that removes the non-indigene's political rights. The constitutional requirement that the governor be an indigene. The local government rule that the chairman be an indigene. The party rule that the candidate be an indigene. The extraction is performed by the constitutional requirement, by the local government rule, by the party rule, or by the community exclusion.

The subject conforms by surrendering political rights. What is extracted is the political rights themselves — the right to contest, to be appointed, to participate. The extraction transfers the rights from the non-indigene to the indigene, with the non-indigene reduced to a tax-paying resident without political voice.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The non-indigene who cannot contest loses the option to political participation, which is to say, loses the option to self-governance in the territory where they live. The non-indigene who cannot be appointed loses the option to professional advancement. The non-indigene who is excluded from the party loses the option to political organisation.

The witness is the person who knows of the extraction and does not intervene. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the indigene who benefits from the exclusion of non-indigenes from political rights without personally commanding the extraction.

3.6 Extraction Triad: Migrant Equal Access to Services

The extractor is the state that charges the non-indigene more for services. The university that charges the non-indigene fee. The scholarship board that denies the non-indigene the scholarship. The state civil service that denies the non-indigene employment. The state hospital that prioritises indigenes. The extraction is performed by the fee, by the denial, by the exclusion, or by the prioritisation.

The subject conforms by paying or by accepting the denial. What is extracted is the equal access itself — the right to education, employment, healthcare, and scholarship on equal terms with the indigene. The extraction transfers the access from the non-indigene to the indigene, with the non-indigene paying more for less.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The non-indigene student who pays higher fees loses the option to equal education, which is to say, loses the option to economic mobility. The non-indigene

worker who cannot access state employment loses the option to economic security. The non-indigene family that is denied state healthcare loses the option to health.

The witness is the person who knows of the extraction and does not intervene. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the indigene who benefits from the non-indigene's exclusion from services without personally commanding the extraction.

3.7 Extraction Triad: Migrant Territorial Claim

The extractor is the system that removes the migrant's territorial claim. The indigene certificate system that classifies the migrant as settler regardless of residence. The traditional ruler system that does not recognise the migrant community's leader. The land tenure system that does not grant the migrant full title. The extraction is performed by the certificate, by the traditional ruler system, by the land tenure system, or by the social treatment.

The subject conforms by accepting the removal. What is extracted is the territorial claim itself — the right to belong, to own, to participate, to be recognised. The extraction transfers the claim from the migrant to the native, with the migrant reduced to a guest in the territory where they live.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The migrant who has lived in a state for three generations loses the option to belonging, which is to say, loses the option to a life that is not mediated by guest status. The migrant whose community leader is not recognised loses the option to political representation. The migrant who cannot obtain full land title loses the option to economic security.

The witness is the person who knows of the extraction and does not intervene. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the native who benefits from the migrant's loss of territorial claim without personally commanding the extraction.

3.8 Extraction Triad: Territory Resources for Native Exclusive Benefit

The extractor is the system that directs the territory's resources to the native's exclusive benefit. The derivation principle that directs 13% of oil revenue to oil-producing states, but only for the indigenes. The host community agreement that directs corporate benefits to the indigenous community, excluding non-indigene residents. The traditional ruler system that directs land rights to the indigene. The extraction is performed by the derivation, by the agreement, by the land rights, or by the distribution.

The subject conforms by accepting the exclusion. What is extracted is the resource itself — the oil revenue, the corporate benefit, the land right, the distribution. The extraction transfers the resource from the territory (where both indigenes and non-indigenes live) to the indigene exclusively, with the non-indigene receiving nothing despite their residence and contribution.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The non-indigene community in the oil-producing state loses the option to the derivation benefit, which is to say, loses the option to the resource that is extracted from the territory where they live. The non-indigene community near the corporation loses

the option to the corporate benefit. The non-indigene who is excluded from the distribution loses the option to economic participation.

The witness is the person who knows of the extraction and does not intervene. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the corporation that benefits from the division between indigene and non-indigene (which prevents unified community resistance) without personally commanding the extraction.

Nascent forms of this system include: 'Indigene' vs 'non-indigene', 'Sons of the soil', 'This is our land', 'Go back to where you came from', 'You are a guest here', Indigene certificate, 'State of origin', Catchment area, Non-indigene fee, Residency requirement for political office, 'You cannot contest election here', 'You cannot get state scholarship', 'Host community', Host community agreement, 13% derivation, 'Resource control', 'Our oil', Fulani herdsmen as settlers, The migrant quarter, The border community, The border closure, The deportee.

SECTION 3 · NAIVE APPROACH

3. The Disciplinary Domain

When the eight triads above link into networks, Territorialism scales. Both hierarchical and community-based forms are visible in every Nigerian institution that organises territorial belonging.

4.1 Disciplinary Hierarchy — Nested Stars

Peak Triad-Node

At the peak is the triad where the highest territorial authority enforces on the layer below. In the state hierarchy, the peak is the Governor who is an indigene, enforcing on the Secretary, who enforces on the Local Government Chairman who is an indigene, who enforces on the non-indigene resident. In the traditional ruler hierarchy, the peak is the first-class chief who is from the host community, enforcing on second-class chiefs, who enforce on district heads, who enforce on the migrant community leader with no official recognition.

In the corporate hierarchy, the peak is the company headquarters in the territory, enforcing on the host community liaison, who enforces on indigene workers, who enforce on non-indigene workers. In the resource hierarchy, the peak is the federal government collecting the derivation, enforcing on the state government receiving the derivation, who enforces on the host community receiving the 13%, who enforces on the non-indigene community receiving nothing.

Middle Triad-Nodes

The middle nodes are where the chain's character is clearest. The Permanent Secretary who is an indigene and who defers to the Governor in the morning demands deference from the Director who is a non-indigene in the afternoon. The district head who is from the host community and who defers to the first-class chief in the morning demands deference from the migrant community leader in the afternoon. The middle is where Territorialism reproduces — the native who is enforced on by the peak enforces on the migrant below.

Bottom Triad-Node

At the bottom is the non-indigene resident — the person who has migrated to a state that is not their 'state of origin,' who lives there, works there, pays taxes there, but who is classified as a 'settler' or 'non-indigene' regardless of how long they have lived there. The non-indigene resident is the one who pays the higher fees, who cannot contest elections, who cannot obtain state employment, and who is told 'you are a guest here.' The bottom is where the system's extraction is most concentrated.

4.2 Disciplinary Community — Distributed Network

A Disciplinary Community is a distributed network. The witness of one Territorialism triad becomes the enforcer of another. The system spreads laterally through any person who has witnessed territorial

enforcement without dissenting.

The Host Community Associations

The host community associations circulate Territorialism laterally across the indigenous community. The association that mobilises the host community for corporate benefits, that negotiates the host community agreement, that excludes non-indigene residents from the negotiation. The associations reproduce the territory-resources-for-native extraction triad across the community.

The Indigene Solidarity Networks

The indigene solidarity networks circulate Territorialism laterally across the indigenous population. The network that mobilises indigenes for political claims, that organises the ‘sons of the soil’ movement, that pressures non-indigenes to accept guest status. The networks reproduce the native-right-to-rule triad across the population.

The ‘Sons of the Soil’ Movements

The ‘sons of the soil’ movements circulate Territorialism laterally through political mobilisation. The movement that demands ‘indigenes first’ in employment, that demands the governorship for the indigene, that demands the expulsion of the settler. The movements reproduce the native-right-to-rule triad through political action.

The Landowners’ Associations

The landowners’ associations circulate Territorialism laterally through land claims. The association that asserts the indigene’s land right, that challenges the non-indigene’s title, that pressures the non-indigene tenant. The associations reproduce the migrant-territorial-claim extraction triad through land enforcement.

The Herders’ vs Farmers’ Associations

The herders’ and farmers’ associations circulate Territorialism laterally through the conflict over grazing routes and farmland. The farmer’s association that claims the land as indigene territory. The herder’s association that claims the grazing route as traditional right. The associations reproduce the territorial-origin-as-political-category triad through the conflict, with the farmer framed as ‘indigene’ and the herder framed as ‘settler.’

SECTION 4 · NAIVE APPROACH

4. The Structural Domain

Run the Ship of Theseus test. When the original colonial administrators who created the Native Authority system are dead and replaced, when the associations are disbanded and reform, what is consistent? What outlives both individuals and groups?

Territorialism leaves all three residues. Almost every Nigerian institution carries Bureaucracy, Stratification, and Classification from Territorialism simultaneously.

5.1 Bureaucracy — Enduring Rules and Procedures

Territorialism's bureaucracy is the codified territorial-belonging structure. The 1999 Constitution's indigene/settler provisions: the **indigene certificate** that proves territorial belonging, the **state of origin** that classifies every Nigerian by territorial origin, the **residency requirement** for political office that requires the candidate to be an indigene, and the **non-indigene fee** in state institutions that charges the non-indigene more.

The **derivation principle** (Section 162(2) of the 1999 Constitution) directs 13% of oil revenue to oil-producing states. The principle addresses the territorial claim to resources but does not address the non-indigene community's interest. The **Land Use Act 1978** vests all land in state governors, creating the 'host community' concept and the territorial claim to land.

The **host community agreement** as corporate practice codifies the relationship between the corporation and the indigenous community, excluding non-indigene residents. The **traditional ruler recognition laws** rank host-community chiefs above migrant-community leaders. The **chieftaincy laws** codify the hierarchy of traditional rulers by territorial origin. The **Nigerian Immigration Act** controls external territorial boundaries, extending the territorial logic to the international border. The original colonial authors are dead. The bureaucracy lives.

5.2 Stratification — Enduring Zero-Sum Rankings

Territorialism's stratification is the daily experience of territorial rank in every institutional encounter. **Native/migrant** — the native ranks above the migrant in political rights, in access to services, in social recognition. **Indigene/non-indigene** — the indigene ranks above the non-indigene in university fees, in employment, in political office.

Host/guest — the host ranks above the guest in territorial belonging. **Owner/occupier** — the owner ranks above the occupier in land rights. **Settler/landowner** — the landowner ranks above the settler in territorial claim. **Rooted/mobile** — the rooted ranks above the mobile in social standing.

Belonger/stranger — the believer ranks above the stranger in community recognition. The ranking is in the air; it does not need to be announced.

5.3 Classification — Enduring Categorical Divisions

Territorialism's classification is the set of categorical names that organise every Nigerian into territorial categories. **Native** and **migrant** — the universal pair, with native as the legitimate and migrant as the temporary. **Indigene** and **non-indigene** — the administrative pair, with indigene as the rights-holder and non-indigene as the rights-denied.

Host and **guest** — the community pair. **Owner** and **occupier** — the land pair. **Son of the soil** and **stranger** — the belonging pair. **Rooted** and **mobile** — the permanence pair. **Belonger** and **outsider** — the community pair. **Host community** and **migrant community** — the corporate pair. The classification does the work before any individual enforcer shows up. A Nigerian walking into a state university admissions office is already classified; the officer does not need to ask 'are you an indigene?' because the form already requires the certificate.

SECTION 5

5. The Hegemonic Domain: The Ascension Ritual

Is Territorialism ascended? Yes on all three counts. It produces all three structural residues including Stratification (so Internalised Domination applies). It has working Canon and Practice mechanisms. The vast majority of Nigerians cannot imagine a society without the indigene/settler distinction, without the state-of-origin form, without the non-indigene fee — despite the fact that territorial identity as political category is a colonial construction.

6.1 Canon — Rewriting History

Canon is the present belief that the indigene/settler distinction has always been so. The origination of the structural residues — the Native Authority system, the indigene certificate, the derivation principle — has been forgotten. The average Nigerian now takes the indigene/settler distinction as natural, eternal, and without alternative.

What is forgotten? Territorial identity as political category is a colonial construction. The British colonial state created the Native Authority system, which tied each subject to a territorial ethnic group. The colonial subject was administered through their Native Authority, which was tied to their territorial origin. The post-colonial state retained this system as the ‘indigene/settler’ distinction, transforming the colonial administrative category into a post-colonial political category.

Also forgotten: that pre-colonial Nigerian territorial boundaries were more fluid. The Yoruba who settled in Hausa territory. The Hausa trader who settled in Yoruba territory. The Igbo who settled in Ijaw territory. Each settlement was unremarkable before the colonial state fixed the boundaries and classified the settler as non-indigene. The derivation principle was introduced by the colonial mining and oil regimes, which allocated royalties to the colonial state rather than to the territory’s inhabitants. The Land Use Act 1978 was a military decree that centralised land in state governors, creating the ‘host community’ concept.

Internalised Domination

Canon produces Internalised Domination because Territorialism produces Stratification. The native’s entitlement to the territory’s resources is now natural, automatic, unquestionable. The indigene who receives the derivation does not experience this as privilege. They experience it as the natural order. The host community’s entitlement to corporate benefits is natural. The son of the soil’s entitlement to rule is natural. The indigene’s entitlement to the governorship is natural.

Internalised Authority

Canon produces Internalised Authority in the Territorialism enforcer regardless of personal material gain. The right to demand the indigene certificate. The right to treat the migrant as guest. The right to deny non-indigene services. The right to demand ‘go back.’ Each is performed by ordinary Nigerians daily — the university officer who demands the certificate, the employer who says ‘indigenes first,’ the community elder who says ‘you are a guest here.’ The right to enforce feels natural, automatic, and legitimate.

Internalised Oppression

Canon produces Internalised Oppression in the migrant subject and the non-indigene. The migrant who believes they are guest. The non-indigene who believes they must accept. The settler who believes they have no claim. The displaced person who believes they have no territory. The teaching is silent; it is in the air.

The deepest form of this is the subject who has absorbed Territorialism so thoroughly that they enforce it on themselves. The non-indigene who says ‘I am a guest here’ to explain why they do not demand equal rights. The non-indigene who says ‘I cannot contest here’ to explain why they do not run for office. The non-indigene who says ‘I must go back’ to explain why they leave the state they have lived in for decades. The rebellion-capable subject has become the self-policing subject.

6.2 Practice — Rewriting Reality

Practice is the second mechanism of the Ascension Ritual. The interpersonal triad is repeated, again and again, until it becomes habit. Pierre Bourdieu called this *habitus* — the sediment of repeated practice in the body. The Nigerian child who learns their ‘state of origin’ before they learn their rights as a citizen is undergoing Practice for Territorialism. The body learns. The mind stops questioning.

By adulthood, the Nigerian has filled in ‘state of origin’ on so many forms, heard ‘you are a guest here’ so many times, navigated the indigene certificate so many times, that the alternative — a society where territorial origin is not a political category — feels like a kind of amputation. The body has been trained. Practice has rewritten reality.

Death — Fast and Slow

Practice produces Death. Fast death in Territorialism is spectacular: the Plateau conflicts of 2001-2010s, with thousands killed — the territorial dimension of the indigene/settler violence in Jos, Barkin Ladi, Riyom, and other local government areas. The herdsmen-farmer conflicts of the 2010s, with thousands killed — the territorial dimension of the farmer as ‘indigene’ and the herder as ‘settler.’ The Niger Delta militancy fueled by territorial claims to oil resources.

The indigene/settler violence in Kaduna, Taraba, and Nasarawa — each with its own death toll, each produced by the territorial logic. The displacement and death in IDP camps where the displaced are treated as non-indigenes — the person who flees violence to a neighbouring state and who is classified as non-indigene in the state of refuge. The border community violence. The death from the host community conflict with the corporation — the community that fights the corporation for territorial control of resources.

Slow death in Territorialism is quiet. Chronic stress of being non-indigene in a state — the non-indigene who has not slept properly in years because every encounter with the state requires the performance of guest status. Mental health collapse from internalised guest status — the non-indigene who has internalised the ‘guest’ label so deeply that their body breaks down under the weight. The slow death of migrant communities’ cultural recognition — the migrant community whose language, festivals, and cultural practices are not recognised because the community is classified as settler.

The non-indigene who cannot access state services — the resident who is denied healthcare, education, and employment because they are not indigene. The non-indigene student who pays higher fees. The non-indigene worker who cannot be promoted. The host community that receives derivation but whose environment is destroyed — the Niger Delta community that receives the 13% but whose creek has been oiled for forty years. The cumulative damage of territorial discrimination. None of these make the news. They are Territorialism’s quiet tax.

Ruth Wilson Gilmore’s definition applies: Territorialism produces group-differentiated vulnerability to premature death. The groups are the non-indigenes, the settlers, the migrants, the displaced, the refugees, the stateless. The premature death is fast (Plateau conflicts, herdsmen-farmer conflicts, Niger Delta militancy, indigene/settler violence, displacement death, border violence, corporate conflict) or slow (stress, internalised guest status, cultural erasure, service denial, fee burden, employment exclusion, environmental destruction, discrimination damage). Every ascended matrix kills. Territorialism kills those whose territorial origin does not fit the native model.

SECTION 6

6. When Did Territorialism Rewrite History?

The framework's historical question: when did Territorialism rewrite history in popular Nigerian living memory?

Pre-colonial Nigerian territorial boundaries were more fluid. The Yoruba who settled in Hausa territory. The Hausa trader who settled in Yoruba territory. The Igbo who settled in Ijaw territory. Territorial identity existed, but it was not the primary political category. The primary political category was the kingdom, the city-state, the village republic — not the territorial origin. The colonial encounter made territorial origin the primary political category.

Colonial codification (1900-1960) created the Native Authority system, which tied each subject to a territorial ethnic group. The 1914 amalgamation combined territorial units that had not been previously unified under a single state. The colonial mining and oil regimes allocated royalties to the colonial state, establishing the derivation principle. The colonial state treated the North, West, and East as territorial units for administrative convenience, creating the regional structure that would become the basis of the indigene/settler distinction.

Post-independence replication continued the construction. The 1960 constitution retained the regional structure. The state creation exercises (1963, 1967, 1976, 1987, 1991, 1996) created new territorial units, each with its own indigene/settler distinction. The Land Use Act 1978 centralised land in state governors, creating the 'host community' concept. The 1999 Constitution codified the derivation principle at 13% and retained the indigene/settler provisions.

The tipping point in popular living memory: **circa 1914 for the amalgamation and the Native Authority system; circa 1960 for the consolidation of the indigene/settler distinction in post-independence law; circa 1978 for the Land Use Act; circa 1999 for the derivation principle in the Constitution.** For Nigerians born after 1960, Territorialism has 'always been' in its current form. They cannot recall a time when territorial origin was not a political category, when the indigene certificate did not exist, when the non-indigene fee was not charged.

SECTION 7

7. Fill in the Blank: A Self-Examination

The framework asks two questions of every subject of every ascended matrix. The blanks are for you.

Question 1: When did Territorialism rewrite your reality?

When did the system teach you that you could not rebel? The moment was: _____. The year was: _____. The person or institution who first made you feel that challenging the indigene/settler distinction was impossible was: _____. The place was: _____. What you wanted to say but did not say was: _____. What you did instead was: _____. What you told yourself about why you did not say it was: _____. The territorial classification you assumed in that moment was: _____. What you lost, in that moment, that you have not got back since, was: _____. The enforcement form at the centre of the moment (indigene certificate, non-indigene fee, political exclusion, expulsion threat, service denial, resource exclusion) was: _____.

Question 2: How is Territorialism causing your Death?

How is the system shortening your life right now? The form of Death I am most afraid of from Territorialism is (fast/slow): _____. The specific way it is happening in my body is: _____. (For example: the chronic stress of being non-indigene in a state; the insomnia from years of being told I am a guest; the loss of self from years of being told I do not belong; the breakdown I had in 20__ that I have never fully recovered from; the non-indigene fee I could not afford; the political office I could not contest; the state employment I was denied; the scholarship I was refused; the violence I survived in the indigene/settler conflict; the environmental destruction of my host community; the displacement that made me a non-indigene in the state of refuge.) The matrix's name for what is happening to me is: _____. My own name for it is: _____.

If you filled in the blanks honestly, you have just located yourself inside Territorialism. The next time the triad assembles — the next time the indigene certificate is demanded, the next time the non-indigene fee is charged, the next time 'you are a guest here' is said — you will be able to see the system moving through you. That sight is the beginning of abolition.

SECTION 8

8. Endnotes & References

References cited inline in this chapter, in APA format. Cumulative references from Chapters 1 through 17 are also included where they recur.

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Coming Next

Chapter 19 will take up State Sovereignty / Statism — the state’s claim to exclusive authority over all persons within its territory, enforced through monopoly on legitimate violence, taxation, conscription, and control of legal personhood. The framework’s outline notes that gangs and warlord systems are the Nascent and Mature stages respectively of this matrix. State Sovereignty overlaps with Retributivism (Chapter 13, which supplies the prison infrastructure) and with Territorialism (Chapter 18, which supplies the territorial claim). The framework separates them so that the state-sovereignty logic specifically can be studied and dismantled. This is the last Fundamental Matrix chapter.

If you are reading this chapter as part of the framework in progress, the Fundamental Matrices list concludes with Chapter 19 (State Sovereignty / Statism). After that, the Intersectional Matrices chapter follows, then the Aggregations chapter, then the Other Topics of Note chapter. The pattern is now set.